

STEPHEN (SALIM) OTIENO

Junior Data Scientist

Machine Learning Enthusiast

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Portfolio: salimstephen.vercel.app

GitHub: github.com/salimstephen | LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/otienostephen991

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Junior Data Scientist with a strong foundation in **Python**, **SQL**, **Machine Learning**, and **data analysis**, supported by hands-on project experience and six professional certifications from ALX Africa. Passionate about transforming data into actionable insights through analytical thinking and practical machine learning solutions. Committed to continuous learning and applying Data Science to solve real-world problems through practical machine learning solutions and data-driven decision-making.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, SQL

Data Science & Machine Learning:

Machine Learning, Data Analysis, Feature Engineering,

Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn

Data Visualization: Matplotlib, Seaborn

Databases: MySQL

Tools: Git, GitHub, Jupyter Notebook, VS Code

Web Technologies: React, Vite

Productivity: Microsoft Excel, Google Sheets

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Data Cleaning & Preprocessing
- Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)
- Machine Learning Fundamentals
- Feature Engineering
- Recommendation Systems
- Problem Solving

FEATURED PROJECT

Movie Recommendation System using Content-Based Filtering

Python | Pandas | Scikit-learn | TF-IDF Vectorization | Cosine Similarity | Git | GitHub

GitHub Repository: github.com/salimstephen/movie-recommendation-project

- Developed a content-based movie recommendation system that generates personalized movie recommendations using TF-IDF vectorization and cosine similarity.

- Preprocessed and cleaned movie metadata to prepare it for feature extraction and similarity analysis.
- Applied **Natural Language Processing (NLP)** techniques to transform movie genres and descriptions into numerical feature vectors.
- Implemented a recommendation function capable of returning relevant movie suggestions based on user-selected titles.
- Documented the project using Git and GitHub, maintaining a well-structured repository with version control throughout development.

CERTIFICATIONS

All certifications issued by ALX Africa.

- Data Science
- AI Career Essentials (AiCE)
- Data Analytics
- Python
- Professional Foundations
- AI Starter Kit

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Delivery Rider | Self-Employed

Nairobi, Kenya

2021 – Present

- Managed 10–20 customer deliveries daily across Nairobi while maintaining timely service and customer satisfaction.
- Planned efficient delivery routes across multiple locations to optimize travel time and maximize daily productivity.
- Handle customer interactions professionally, maintaining strong communication and a high standard of service.
- Worked independently to manage daily schedules, prioritize deliveries, and solve logistical challenges while maintaining reliable customer service.
- Balanced full-time work with continuous professional development, completing multiple certifications in Data Science, Artificial Intelligence, and Python.

EDUCATION

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology (JKUAT)

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology (*Incomplete*) 2021

Completed foundational university coursework in Information Technology before transitioning due to financial constraints. Continued professional development through industry-recognized certifications and practical Data Science projects.